

Have students close their eyes first

Picture this: You're on a field trip sitting in a dark movie theater, the room dimly lit by the images on the screen. A person, perhaps a classmate, perhaps a friend puts a tub of buttery popcorn in your lap and you instinctively, thoughtlessly, take it. You're too engrossed in trying to understand mystery of the movie, your eyes glued to the screen, to even register who it was. The tension in the film is rising, and as you lean forward in your seat, you reach into the tub of popcorn resting in your lap, expecting the familiar, satisfying crunch of salty, buttery kernels.

But instead, your fingers sink into something soft. Your brain struggles to process the sensation, expecting the light, fluffy texture of popcorn but encountering something warm and squishy. It feels almost gelatinous, with a sticky residue that clings to your skin as you pull your hand out of the tub.

The darkness of the theater makes it hard to see what you're holding, but your nostrils are quick to correct course. There's an immediate, sickening realization as the warmth seeps into your hand. Your heart pounds, and you fumble for your phone, switching on the flashlight.

The phone casts an small white spotlight on what you're holding, and your stomach churns as you see it—human feces, smeared across your fingers, dark and foul. The sharp, acrid stench hits your tastebuds as you gasp (go ahead, take a deep gasp), making you gag. The texture is horrifyingly wrong, sticky and wet where it shouldn't be, clinging to your skin in thick, oily smears.

As your hand shakes, you realize your hand is not the only thing moving.

Pale, writhing shapes begin to emerge from the mess. They're long, thin, and disturbingly active. Small parasitic worms, white and glistening, wriggle out of the feces, their bodies slither as they try to escape the sudden exposure to the light. The worms twist their tiny, segmented bodies contracting and as if they've been disturbed from a dark, hidden place. They look like grubs under muddy rocks, maggots moving through rotten potatoes.

Your mind races with horror as you realize the creatures are crawling over your hand, their movements purposeful, almost eager. They're seeking something—a new host, perhaps—and your warm skin is the perfect target. You can feel their tiny bodies squirming between your fingers as they search for a way inside, for an opening where they can burrow and thrive.

The revulsion is overwhelming, a primal disgust that makes your skin crawl. It's as if every fiber of your being is screaming at you to get it off, to rid yourself of this revolting, contaminated mess. The worms seem to sense your panic, their movements quickening, driven by an instinct to survive and spread.

In the darkness of the theater, the world around you seems to close in, the sound of the movie fading into the background as all you can focus on is the grotesque, writhing mass in your hand. It's a scene that sears itself into your memory, the visceral, gut-wrenching fear of encountering something so vile, so wrong, that your body reacts with a deep, evolutionary aversion—a desperate need to flee from the source of disease and contamination